Ansel Zeng

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EDUCATION

University of Southern California, Viterbi School of Engineering Jan 2026 – Dec 2027
MS Candidate, Computer Science
- AI Hackathon 2026 by LA Hacks – Winner of [Major League Hacking] Best Use of Snowflake API

Western University, Ivey Business School Sept 2020 – June 2025
BSc, Computer Science + HBA, Honours Business Administration
- Completed a dual degree between the CS Faculty and Ivey Business School; exchange semester at Tsinghua University
- Dean's Honour List, Deloitte Innovation Forum Case Competition (2nd Place), Western Scholarship of Distinction

EXPERIENCE

USC Information Sciences Institute (SPHERE), Junior Operations Engineer June 2026 – Present
- Deploying a production RAIDZ2 ZFS storage server from bare metal to support the distributed testbed, and author an Ansible role that provisions datasets, configures NFS exports, enforces CIDR-scoped access control, and integrates firewalld
- Performing multi-master failover and fault-recovery testing during k8s control-plane upgrades, and leading an acoustic and thermal tuning initiative across 140+ servers, cutting average fan speed 14% via custom Redfish fan-control profiles

Ivey Centre for Building Sustainable Value, Software Engineer July 2025 – July 2026
- Shipped a live, cross-platform Flutter mobile app, now used by 40+ farmers, with state-driven logic, input validation, error handling, relational data models, and real-time synchronization to support shared access across distributed users
- Designed and implemented a scalable PostgreSQL backend with structured relational schemas, CRUD pipelines, and event-driven updates, collaborating closely with faculty advisors to align system architecture with research decisions

TELUS, Software Engineer Intern May 2023 – Aug 2023
- Owned the development of an internal ticket management system for a DevOps team, defining task assignment logic and state transitions while optimizing ticket creation and vendor coordination across teams of 700+ engineers
- Contributed to Open RAN integration initiatives with industry partners (Rakuten, Samsung), supporting network automation and system validation workflows related to 5G network deployment and Zero-Touch Provisioning

Royal Bank of Canada, Software Engineer Intern May 2022 – Aug 2022
- Enhanced auto-adjudication pipelines within retail banking's mortgage division by applying decision-tree ranking logic and rule-based scoring to identify low-quality applications, reducing manual review and improving system throughput
- Built and tested low-latency GraphQL backend services handling 100+ requests per second, implementing 50+ unit tests to validate complex logic paths, catch edge cases, and ensure production-grade robustness during legacy system migration

Tweebaa (Startup), UX/UI Designer Intern May 2021 – Aug 2021
- Collaborated with a global engineering team to define app architecture and technical requirements for a startup launch, translating user research into structured specs that shaped platform decisions and boosted client feedback 30%
- Created a comprehensive portfolio of 500+ user-centric Figma designs, user flow diagrams, sitemaps, and mock-ups

PROJECTS

USC InfoLab (Wearables for Health Toolkit), Research Assistant Feb 2026 – May 2026
- Redesigned a research platform's core data model from single-study to multi-project architecture for launching notebook-based analytics, and built admin-facing user-management and dataset-assignment tooling for granular per-user access

Hack Western, Web Team Lead March 2021 – Feb 2024
- Led a team of eight developers in the end-to-end development of Hack Western's dynamic landing page, live site, and robust application portal supporting over 1,000 applicants, collaborating across design and engineering functions

SpotGPT, Creator July 2023 – Aug 2023
- Developed an AI-driven music recommendation system by integrating Spotify's audio features API with OpenAI's LLMs, designing prompt-based logic pipelines to generate context-aware playlists based on user preferences and audio attributes

SKILLS

Technical: Java, Python, JavaScript/TypeScript (React, Node, Next), SQL, Bash, C++, Git, Kubernetes, Docker, Linux, MongoDB
Product Management: User Interviews, Road Mapping, Issue Prioritization, Technical Systems Design, Market Research